

THE WELL LIVED CITIZEN

CURATED RESALE & LEGACY PLANNING

Product Evaluation & Recommended Value

PREPARED FOR

Rachel

DATE

July 21, 2026

EVALUATION #

WLC-002

PRODUCT DETAILS

ITEM NAME

Collection of Pre-Columbian Mayan-Style Terracotta Head Fragments

CATEGORY

Ceramics / Antiquities

ORIGIN

Mesoamerica (likely Mayan region)

ERA

Pre-Columbian (c. 250 AD – 900 AD)

CONDITION

Good — fragments with natural wear consistent with age

MATERIALS

Terracotta (Clay)

DESCRIPTION & NOTES

Collection of multiple terracotta head fragments reflecting Pre-Columbian Mesoamerican artistry. Pieces show stylized facial features and characteristic details of the Mayan ceramic tradition. Hand-molded from local clays, such pieces are often found as part of larger funerary or ritual offerings. Market value is determined by clarity of facial features, provenance of the finds, and preservation of the clay structure. Multiple pieces in a collection lot can sell together or be broken out individually depending on market strategy.

VALUATION

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APP REFERENCE PRICE (COLLECTION)

\$200 – \$600

COMPARABLE SINGLE FRAGMENTS (GALLERY)

\$50 – \$150 each

HIGH-END GALLERY RANGE (1STDIBS, ARTSY)

\$680 – \$6,000+

REALISTIC SELL RANGE (THIS COLLECTION)

\$150 – \$400

Pricing on Pre-Columbian fragments is all over the map. Individual small head fragments (2" range) sell at specialty galleries like Time Vault Gallery for \$50–\$150 with provenance documentation. On 1stDibs, gallery-priced Mayan pieces average \$6,450 but those are museum-quality with documented provenance and collector pedigree. Without provenance paperwork, this collection realistically lands in the \$150–\$400 range as a lot, or \$40–\$100 per individual fragment depending on detail and size. The app's \$200–\$600 estimate is optimistic without authentication documents.

WHERE & HOW TO SELL

EBAY

Largest audience for Pre-Columbian pieces. List as "Mayan-style" unless authenticated. Completed listings show fragments selling \$30–\$200. Best for individual pieces.

\$30 – \$200/piece

ETSY

Active market for terracotta antiquities. Similar face masks and fragments listed there (visible in comparables). Good for reaching collectors directly.

\$50 – \$150/piece

SPECIALTY DEALERS

Ancient Resource, Time Vault Gallery, Sands of Time. They buy collections outright or consign. Requires photos and any provenance info available.

Consignment or buyout

AUCTION HOUSES

LiveAuctioneers, Heritage Auctions for higher-value lots. Best if collection can be authenticated. They handle the buyer audience but take 15–25% commission.

15–25% seller premium

RED FLAGS & SELLER ADVISORY

PROVENANCE & AUTHENTICATION — CRITICAL

Pre-Columbian artifacts are a legally sensitive category. Without documentation proving the pieces were acquired before 1970 (the UNESCO convention cutoff) or legally exported, selling can carry legal risk. US law (National Stolen Property Act) can apply to artifacts removed from their country of origin without authorization. The seller should gather any acquisition history, family records, or dealer receipts showing when and how these were obtained. If the pieces came from an estate or collection, that documentation matters.

AUTHENTICATION

"Mayan-style" is not the same as authenticated Pre-Columbian. Without a certificate of authenticity from a recognized expert or lab (thermoluminescence testing), listings should use qualified language: "Mayan-style terracotta fragments, age undetermined." Misrepresenting reproductions as genuine artifacts creates significant legal and marketplace liability.

PLATFORM RESTRICTIONS

eBay and Etsy both have policies on antiquities. eBay requires sellers to comply with all applicable laws regarding cultural property. Listings can be pulled if flagged. Frame the listing carefully with accurate, qualified descriptions.

SHIPPING

Terracotta fragments are fragile. Individual wrapping, padding, and rigid boxing required. Insure for declared value. Lower risk than the framed glass painting but still needs care.

DAYNA'S RECOMMENDATION

BEFORE LISTING

Get any provenance documentation Rachel has — purchase receipts, estate records, dealer correspondence, anything that shows acquisition history. This is the single biggest factor in both the price ceiling and the legal safety of selling these pieces. Without it, we list conservatively with qualified language.

SELLING STRATEGY

If provenance is available: consign with a specialty antiquities dealer or list on eBay at \$100–\$150 per fragment with documented history. If no provenance: sell as a collection lot locally or on eBay at \$150–\$250 for the group, using "Mayan-style" language and condition-as-found descriptions. Consider reaching out to Ancient Resource or Time Vault Gallery for a dealer buyout quote — they handle the authentication and buyer audience, and Rachel avoids the legal exposure of listing independently.

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This evaluation reflects the professional opinion of The Well Lived Citizen based on current market conditions and comparable sales data. Values are estimates and actual sale prices may vary. Seller is responsible for compliance with all applicable laws regarding the sale of antiquities and cultural property.